

Remote Work Policy

Northgate Group — HR Policy | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: People Operations

1. Purpose and Scope

This Remote Work Policy sets out who is eligible to work remotely at Northgate Group, what equipment the company provides, the working hours and communication expectations that apply to remote workers, and the process for requesting and approving a remote working arrangement.

2. Eligibility Criteria

Remote work is a discretionary arrangement rather than a contractual right. Eligibility is assessed against the requirements of the role and the individual's record of performance.

- The employee must have completed the probation period of three months.
- The role must not require daily physical presence, such as facilities, reception or hardware support.
- The employee must have no live performance improvement plan or formal disciplinary sanction.
- The employee must have a suitable, private work location with a stable broadband connection.

The standard arrangement is up to two remote days per week. Fully remote arrangements are approved only where the role has been designated as remote-first at the point of hire.

3. Equipment Provision

The company provides a laptop, a headset and a docking station to every employee approved for remote work. A second monitor and an ergonomic chair may be requested where the employee works remotely on three or more days per week. Equipment is requested by raising an IT ticket of type Hardware Issue, stating the device type required and the approved remote working arrangement.

All equipment remains the property of Northgate Group and must be returned on termination of employment or on withdrawal of the remote work arrangement. Employees are responsible for reasonable care of company equipment at home. Loss or damage should be reported through an IT ticket within one working day.

4. Working Hours

Remote workers keep the same contracted hours as office-based colleagues. Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local office time, during which the employee must be contactable and available for meetings. Hours outside the core window may be worked flexibly with the agreement of the line manager.

Employees must record remote working days in the shared team calendar by the end of the preceding week so that coverage is visible. Changing a planned office day to a remote day at short notice requires the line manager's agreement.

5. Communication Expectations

Remote workers are expected to respond to instant messages within one hour during core hours and to email within one business day. Calendars must be kept current and accurate, including blocks for focus time and appointments. Video should be enabled for team meetings and any conversation involving a client.

Any planned absence from the desk of more than one hour during core hours should be reflected in the calendar or the team channel status. Persistent unavailability during core hours is treated as a performance matter and may lead to the arrangement being withdrawn.

6. Approval Process

A remote work request is raised as an HR request in the employee portal and must state the proposed pattern, the work location and the expected start date. The line manager reviews the request first and People Operations records the final decision. A decision is normally given within five business days.

Approved arrangements are reviewed every six months. An arrangement may be varied or withdrawn with 14 days' written notice where business need changes, where performance declines, or where the security requirements in this policy are not being met.

7. Security Requirements

Remote workers must connect to the corporate VPN before accessing any internal system. Public or shared wireless networks must not be used without the VPN active. Devices must lock automatically after five minutes of inactivity and must not be left unattended in a public space.

Company data must not be copied to personal devices, personal cloud storage or personal email. Suspected compromise of a device or account must be reported to IT immediately through the password and account access escalation route.

8. Working Remotely from Abroad

Temporary remote work from another country requires written approval from People Operations at least 30 days in advance because of tax, immigration and data residency implications. Approval is limited to a maximum of 20 working days per calendar year and is not granted for locations subject to sanctions or without adequate data protection arrangements.